*psst. I'm building **Latent Patterns** — a deep technical course on transformers, RAG, agents, and tool calling for developers who want to understand AI from first principles, not surface-level tutorials. Sign up at* **https://latentpatterns.com/** to qualify for early bird pricing. ×

BY **GEOFFREY HUNTLEY** IN **AI** — 17 JAN 2026

don't waste your back pressure

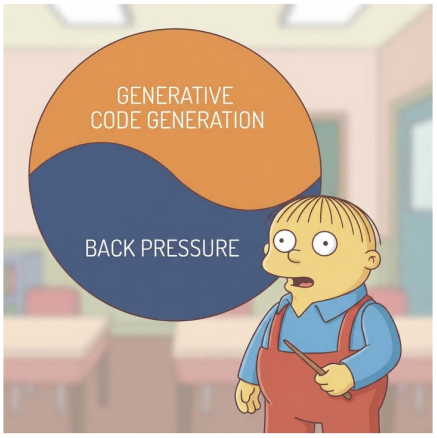
I am fortunate to be surrounded by folks who listen and the link below post will go down as a seminal reading for people interested in AI context engineering.

A simple convo between mates - well Moss translated it into words and i've been waiting for it to come out so I didn't front run him.

Don't waste your back pressure ·
Back pressure for agents You might notice a pattern in the most successful applications of agents over the last year. Projects that ar...
[Moss]

read this and internalise this

Enjoy. This is what engineering now looks like in the post loom/gastown era or even when doing ralph loops.



software engineering is now about preventing failure scenarios and preventing the wheel from turning over through back pressure to the generative function

If you aren't capturing your back-pressure then you are failing as a software engineer.

Back-pressure is part art, part engineering and a whole bung of performance engineering as you need "just enough" to reject invalid generations (aka "hallunications") but if the wheel spins too slow ("tests take a long time to run or for the application to compile") then it's too much resistance.

There are many ways to tune back-pressure and as Moss states it starts with choice of programming language, applying engineering knowledge to design a fast test suite that provides signal but perhaps my favorite one is `pre-commit` hooks (aka prek).

GitHub - j178/prek: ⚡ Better `pre-commit`, re-engineered in Rust
⚡ Better `pre-commit`, re-engineered in Rust. Contribute to j178/prek development by creating an account on GitHub.
GitHub · j178

8/prek
⚡ `pre-commit`, re-engineered in Rust
394 4k 106

Under normal circumstances pre-commit hooks are annoying because they slow down humans but now that humans aren't the ones doing the software development it really doesn't matter anymore.

PREVIOUS
everything is a ralph loop

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teleporting into the future and robbing yourself of retirement projects

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porting software has been trivial for a while now. here's how you do it.

This one is short and sweet. if you want to port a

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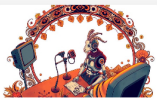

AI

A couple of days ago, I sat down with Vivek Bharathi and dumped my brains. Here's the interview...

0:00 /11:14 1× Below you'll find an AI

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